On the contrary, he could have spilled the beans about his connections with some senior Congress leaders. His arrest could also have provided a reason for Sikh militants to fan out in Punjab and target innocent Hindus in retaliation. It would have been difficult, if not impossible, to control that situation before the elections, which were due within the next eight months. Obviously, the 1 Akbar Road group would not have done anything to jeopardize their chances at the hustings.

It was time for Bhindranwale to go. The precise time, and the manner in which the 'final solution' would be implemented, remained to be worked out. In view of his 'ferocious' image, so very carefully cultivated over the last three years, Bhindranwale could not be seen to have gone meekly. His last fight had to be befitting his image so people could realize what a tough enemy he was. It would, therefore, appear that the Akal Takht's fortification through the smuggling of arms was deliberately overlooked so that when the time came for the 'final solution', Bhindranwale should go fighting till the last man.

It would thus appear that Indira Gandhi's rejection of the SFF operation was based on these considerations rather than on her concern for the lives of innocent civilians. This would become evident from the way Operation Blue Star was conceived, approved and ruthlessly executed, without any concern for civilian casualties or for its impact on the stability of a strategic state like Punjab, and of the nation as a whole.